

SENATE JOINT RESOLUTION 408

By Massey

A RESOLUTION to recognize Lieutenant Colonel Dean Keck, U.S. Marine Corps (Retired) on the occasion of his retirement.

WHEREAS, the members of this General Assembly take great pleasure in paying tribute to a dedicated educator and military officer whose outstanding contributions to his students and community reflect great credit upon himself and the United States Navy Junior Reserve Officer Training Corps (JROTC) program; and

WHEREAS, one such individual is Lieutenant Colonel Dean Keck, U.S. Marine Corps (Retired), who is taking a much-deserved retirement on June 15, 2025, from his position as a JROTC Navy instructor, having faithfully served the JROTC program for ten years; and

WHEREAS, the son of Don and Ede Keck of New Tazewell, Dean Keck was born in New Tazewell in 1962 and attended Claiborne County High School, from which he graduated in 1980; and

WHEREAS, Lt. Col. Keck joined the United States Marine Corps in January 1984 and completed Marine Corps Boot Camp, attaining the rank of Private First Class on March 27, 1984; and

WHEREAS, rising through the ranks, he became a Staff Sergeant and applied for and won admittance to the Warrant Officer Program, subsequently winning promotion to Warrant Officer on February 1, 1996; and

WHEREAS, after applying to and being selected for the Limited Duty Officer Program, he was promoted to the rank of Captain on September 1, 2001; he retired after thirty years of distinguished service with the Marines at the rank of Lieutenant Colonel in January 2014; and

WHEREAS, during his military career, he served four years in Washington, D.C., as the 22nd Color Sergeant of the Marine Corps and was deployed to Iraq in 2003 as a Captain with the 2nd Marine Expeditionary Brigade, Task Force Tarawa; and

WHEREAS, after achieving the rank of Major in 2006, he was again deployed to Iraq, where he served with the U.S. Army 82nd Airborne Division; in 2008, he was deployed to Afghanistan and served with the 101st Airborne Division at Bagram Airfield. He returned to Afghanistan for a final tour of duty in 2009, during which time he served as the Commander for Combat Logistics Company 252 at Camp Leatherneck; and

WHEREAS, after leaving the Marine Corps, Lt. Col. Keck attended ITT Tech, where he earned a degree in network systems administration and launched a career as a Navy JROTC Instructor in 2015; and

WHEREAS, sharing his wisdom and experience, Lt. Col. Keck worked at Fulton High School as a Navy JROTC Instructor for seven years; spent two years at Union County High School, where he helped launch the school's JROTC program and obtain Navy funding; and served this last year as the Navy JROTC Instructor at West High School; and

WHEREAS, his many professional accomplishments aside, Lt. Col. Keck is most thankful for the love and support of his wife of twenty-three years, Kathy Keck; and

WHEREAS, Lt. Col. Dean Keck exemplifies the spirit and allegiance to family and community that are characteristic of a true Tennessean; and

WHEREAS, throughout his estimable career, Lt. Col. Keck has demonstrated the utmost professionalism, ability, and integrity, winning the unbridled respect and admiration of his colleagues, students, and community; now, therefore,

BE IT RESOLVED BY THE SENATE OF THE ONE HUNDRED FOURTEENTH GENERAL ASSEMBLY OF THE STATE OF TENNESSEE, THE HOUSE OF REPRESENTATIVES CONCURRING, that we honor and commend Lieutenant Colonel Dean Keck, U.S. Marine Corps (Retired) on the occasion of his retirement as a Navy JROTC Instructor, thank him for his decades of service to both the U.S. Marine Corps and the State of Tennessee, and extend to him our heartfelt wishes for a happy and fulfilling retirement and every continued success in his future endeavors.

BE IT FURTHER RESOLVED, that an appropriate copy of this resolution be prepared for presentation with this final clause omitted from such copy and upon proper request made to the appropriate clerk, the language appearing immediately following the State seal appear without House or Senate designation.